CORE ITEM UPDATE · INDIA

# Core Item Update: Men's kurtas and sets 2026–28

Menswear is quieter and more versatile.

Forecut Editorial · 11 October 2026



# Overview

Menswear is quieter and more versatile. The straight band-collar kurta is a stable classic, linen sets and pathani suits are rising, and short and asymmetric kurtas carry the fusion energy. Embroidery moves to the neckline and cuffs.

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|---|---|---|---|
| INVEST | TEST | MAINTAIN | REDUCE |

Invest: rising now. Test: emerging. Maintain: at its peak. Reduce: fading.

# The details

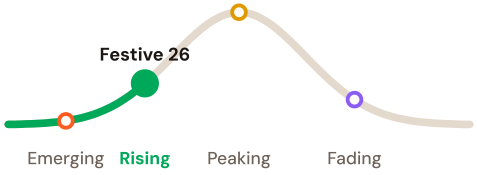
Each detail with its status for Festive 26, its trend curve and what it does next.



INVEST RISING

## Linen kurta sets

Breathable linen and cotton-silk for relaxed celebrations. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



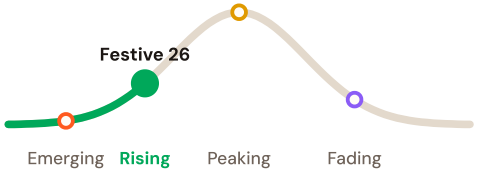

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Fading | |



INVEST RISING

## Short kurtas with jeans

Hip-length kurtas worn with denim for everyday wear. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



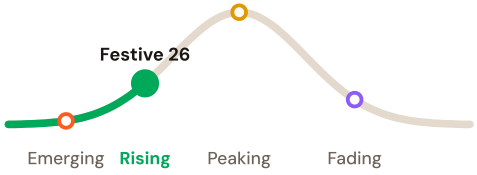

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|---|---|---|
| Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Rising | Festive 27 Peaking |
| Summer 28 Peaking | Festive 28 Fading | |



INVEST RISING

## Asymmetric-hem kurtas

Angled or layered hems for a modern kurta. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



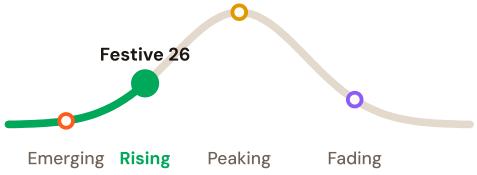

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|---|---|---|
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INVEST RISING

## Pathani suits

Collared Pathani kurtas with salwar, in solid tones. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.



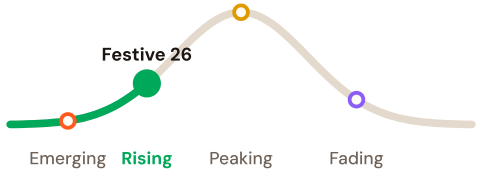

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|---|---|---|
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INVEST RISING

## Neckline and cuff embroidery

Subtle embroidery placed only at the neckline and cuffs. Growth is building. Commit to it in your next range.




Festive 26 Rising | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking | Summer 28 | Festive 28



MAINTAIN PEAKING

## Straight kurta with band collar

Straight kurtas with a Nehru (band) collar and churidar or straight trousers. At its height. Keep in core ranges without over-buying.




Festive 26 Peaking | Summer 27 Peaking | Festive 27 Peaking

Peaking

Fading

Summer 28
Peaking

Festive 28
Peaking

## How to update your men's kurtas and sets range

- Keep the straight band-collar kurta in calm handloom colours.
- Invest in linen kurta sets for summer weddings.
- Add short kurtas styled with denim for younger customers.
- Move embroidery to neckline and cuffs, tone-on-tone.

See every men's kurtas and sets detail with design notes and downloadable cards in the India Forecast 2026–28.

Statuses are Forecut's forecast for India: Festive 26 (Oct 2026 – Feb 2027), Summer 27 (Mar – Jul 2027), Festive 27 (Aug – Dec 2027), and long-range outlooks for Summer 28 (Mar – Jul 2028) and Festive 28 (Aug – Dec 2028). Sources: India trends summarise public coverage of Lakmé Fashion Week x FDCI 2026 (Harper's Bazaar India, Free Press Journal), Aza Fashions festive and ethnic trend guides, Lashkaraa colour and silhouette trends 2026, Pearl Academy Gen Z trend reports, Gully Labs, Global Indian (Prada SS26 Kolhapuri-inspired sandals) and Outlook Business (Gen Z and e-retail).